Comparison of E-Waste Rules in 5 Asian Countries

India • Japan • China • South Korea • Singapore

Feature	India	Japan	China	South Korea	Singapore
Main regulation	E-Waste (Management) Rules, 2022	Home Appliance Recycling Law + Small Home Appliance Recycling Law	Regulations for Recovery & Disposal of Waste Electrical/Electronic Products	Act on Resource Circulation of Electrical & Electronic Equipment and Vehicles	Resource Sustainability Act / regulated e-waste system
Main approach	EPR-based system	Producer + retailer responsibility	Government-regulated recovery and recycling	Producer responsibility + resource circulation	EPR-based system
Producer responsibility	Producers must meet specified EPR/recycling obligations	Manufacturers/importers recycle specified appliances	Producers/importers participate in regulated recycling/disposal financing	Producers have recovery/recycling obligations	Producers are responsible for collection and treatment
Collection	Registered producers/recyclers and EPR system	Retailers collect specified old appliances	Formal collection/recovery system	Producer/recycler collection systems	Producer-led collection system
Recycling / recovery	EPR targets assigned to producers	Specified recycling-rate requirements	Regulated treatment/disposal standards	Recovery and recycling obligations	Collection and treatment obligations
Online / reporting	CPCB EPR portal and online returns	Administrative / record-based system	Government supervision and reporting	Government reporting / management	NEA registration and reporting
Hazardous substances	Environmentally sound management required	Hazardous substances such as CFCs properly recovered	Hazardous components safely treated	Hazardous-substance restrictions	Pollutant treatment and RoHS-related controls
Consumer role	Hand e-waste to authorized channels	Consumers generally pay collection/recycling fees for specified appliances	Consumers participate through recovery channels	Consumers return products through collection systems	Consumers use designated collection points
Special feature	Digital EPR certificates and recycling targets	Strong manufacturer–retailer–consumer responsibility model	Government-regulated and licensed treatment model	Resource-circulation + eco-design/hazardous-substance controls	Structured producer-led collection and treatment system

Overall comparison

India focuses on digital EPR tracking and recycling certificates. Japan emphasizes manufacturer, retailer and consumer responsibility. China uses strong government regulation and licensed treatment. South Korea combines recycling with resource-circulation and hazardous-substance controls. Singapore uses a structured producer-led EPR collection and treatment system.

Sources: Government of India / CPCB E-Waste EPR Portal; UNCRD State of the 3Rs in Asia and the Pacific; Singapore Statutes Online. Rules and implementation details can be amended, so the official sources should be checked for the latest legal version.